Fast Lane



Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Master Class

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Version October 2026

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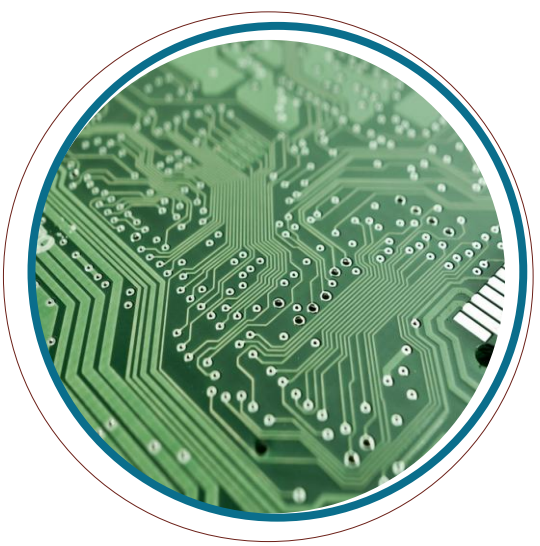
Module 5

Additional Configurations

Module 5 Contents:

- Advanced Features - Overview
- Indicators
- Web Content Filtering
- Vulnerability Management

Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/onboard-windows-client



Advanced Features

Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/overview-attack-surface-reduction

Advanced Features

Overview

- Restrict correlation to within scoped device groups
- Enable EDR in block mode
- Automatically resolve alerts
- Allow or block file
- Hide potential duplicate device records
- Custom network indicators
- Tamper protection
- Show user details
- Skype for business integration

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Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/overview-attack-surface-reduction

Advanced Features

Overview

- Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps
- Web content filtering
- Unified audit log
- Device discovery
- Download quarantined files
- Default to streamlined connectivity
- Apply streamlined connectivity settings …
- Live Response (3 times)
- Share endpoint alerts with Microsoft Compliance Center

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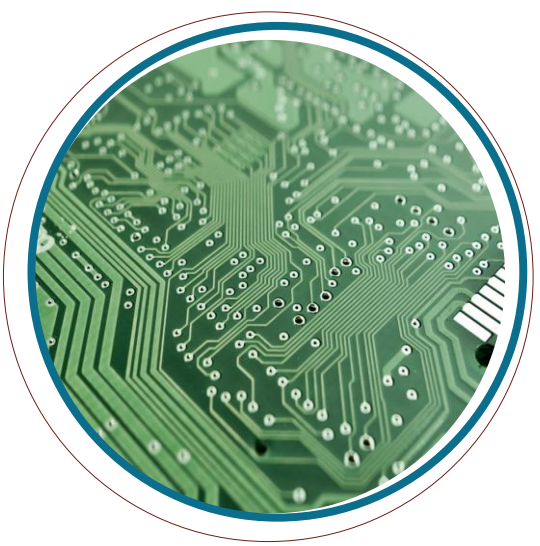
Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/overview-attack-surface-reduction

Advanced Features

Overview

- Isolation Exclusion Rules
- Allow restricted security operations during onboarding
- Microsoft Intune connection
- Authenticated telemetry
- Preview Features

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Indicators

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Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/manage-indicators

Indicators

'*An Indicator of compromise (IoC) is a forensic artifact, observed on the network or host. […]* This capability gives SecOps the ability to set a list of indicators for detection and for blocking (prevention and response).'

Useful for

- customer known bad files e.g.
- allow false positives

Types



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Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/manage-indicators

Indicators

IoC engines

- Endpoint prevention engine (MDAV)
- Automated Investigation and Remediation (AIR)
- Cloud detection

Enforcement types

- Allow
- Audit
- Warn
- Block execution
- Block and remediate

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Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/manage-indicators

Indicators

Configuration

Prerequisites for all kind of IoCs

- Behavior Monitoring is enabled
- Cloud-based protection is turned on
- Cloud Protection network connectivity is functional
- Antimalware client version > 4.18.1901.x
- OS: Win 10/11; Win 2012 R2 or later (usual requirements)

Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/manage-indicators

Indicators

Configuration - **Files**

Prerequisites

- MDAV in active mode
- File hash computation enabled
  - GPO: Computer Configuration | Administrative Templates | Windows Components | Microsoft Defender AV | MpEngine
  - Policy: Enable file hash computation feature
  - PowerShell:

```
Set-MpPreference -EnableFileHashComputation $true
Get-MpPreference | Format-List -Property EnableFileHashComputation
```

Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/manage-indicators

Indicators

Configuration - **Files**

- Generate File hash of executable (*.exe or *.dll)

```
Get-FileHash -Path 'C:\Temp\notepad++.exe' -Algorithm SHA256
```

- Settings | Endpoints | Rules/Indicators
- Tab 'File hashes' | + Add item

From file investigation page also possible

Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/indicator-file#policy-conflict-handling

Indicators

Policy Conflict handling - **Files/Certs**

- Open documentation

Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/indicator-ip-domain#non-microsoft-edge-and-internet-explorer-processes

Indicators

Configuration - **IPs and URLs**

Prerequisites

- Network protection enabled
- Settings | Endpoints | Adv Features: Custom network indicators: ON

- For Non Microsoft Edge and IE processes
  - TCP, HTTP, HTTPS supported
  - only single IP addresses (no CIDR)
  - not supported in Application Guard sessions

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Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/indicator-ip-domain#ioc-ip-url-and-domain-policy-conflict-handling-order

Indicators

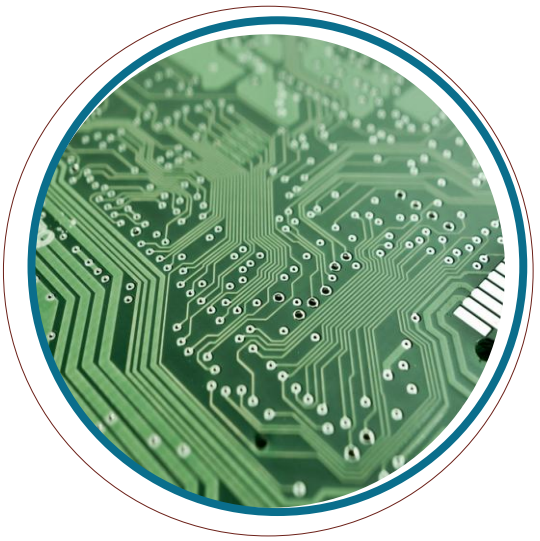
Configuration - **IPs and URLs**

IoC conflict handling order

- *Allow* wins over *Warn* wins over *Block*

- Settings | Endpoints | Rules/Indications
- Tab 'Ip addresses' | + Add item
- Tab 'URLs/domain' | + Add item

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Web Protection

Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-endpoint/web-protection-overview

Web Protection

'Web protection lets you secure your devices against web threats and helps you regulate unwanted content.'

- made up of
  - Web threat protection
  - Web content filtering
  - Custom indicators

Web protection

Web threat protection

- Enabled, if Network protection is enabled

Custom Indicator

- Settings | Adv Features: Custom network indicators: On
- Configured Settings | Endpoint | Rules/Indicators
- Types:
  - IPs
  - URLs/domains

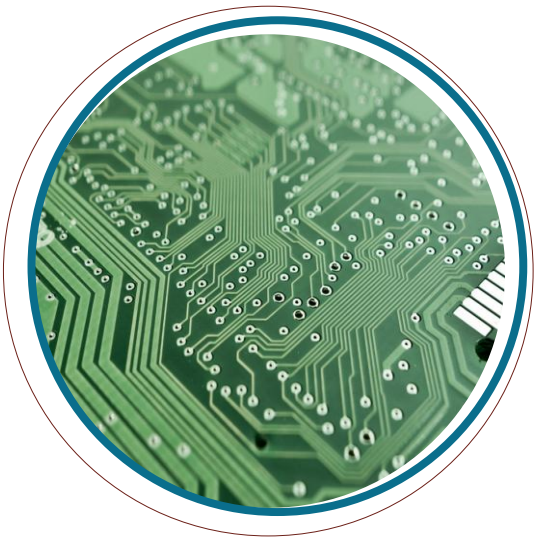
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Web protection

Web content filtering

- Settings | Endpoint | Adv Features: Web content filtering: On
- Configured by policies
  - Settings | Endpoint | Rules/Web content filtering
  - Categories to block
  - Scope: Device Group this filter should be applied

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Vulnerability Managment

Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-vulnerability-management/defender-vulnerability-management

Vulnerability Management

'Vulnerability management serves as an infrastructure for reducing organizational exposure, hardening endpoint surface area, and increasing organizational resilience.'



Vulnerability Management

Standalone license provides all features

MDE P2 Features

Device discovery
Device inventory
Vulnerability assessment
Configuration assessment
Risk based prioritization
Remediation tracking
Continuous monitoring
Software inventory
Software usages insights

Add-On Features

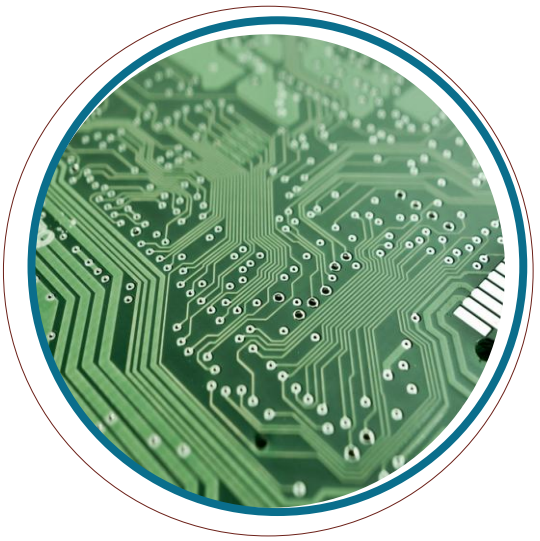
Security baselines assessment
Block vulnerable applications
Browser extensions assessment
Digital certificate assessment
Network share analysis
Hardware and firmware assessment
Authenticated scan for Windows

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Vulnerability Management

- Portal
- Dashboard
- Recommendations
- Remediation
- Inventories
- Weaknesses
  - Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures (CVEs)
- Event timeline

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Endpoint DLP

Source: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/endpoint-dlp-learn-about

Endpoint Data Loss Prevention

'[..] use Microsoft Purview Data Loss Prevention (DLP) to monitor the actions that are being taken on items you've determined to be sensitive and to help prevent the unintentional sharing of those items.

Endpoint data loss prevention (Endpoint DLP) extends the activity monitoring and protection capabilities of DLP to Windows 10/11, macOS […] devices, and Windows certain server versions.'

Three typical scenarios

Scenario	Policy match	Example response
Customer file copied to USB	Sensitive information type in a customer export	Block USB copy and notify the user
Confidential file uploaded to personal cloud storage	Sensitivity label plus a configured restricted domain	Block upload in a supported browser
Employee prints a sensitive HR document	HR label or sensitive information type	Block with override and record justification

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Important Components

- Sensitive Information Types (SITs)
  - pattern-based classifiers.
- Sensitivity Labels
  - classification
  - protection
- Endpoint DLP Policies
  - '… monitor the activities that users take on sensitive items and […] take protective actions.'
  - Source

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Requirements and onboarding

Licences and operating systems

- Microsoft 365 E5 or an eligible Purview add-on
- License each user who benefits from Endpoint DLP
- Windows 10/11: supported, updated builds
- macOS: three latest major releases

Device readiness

- Purview Settings > Device onboarding: enable and onboard devices
- Existing MDE Windows devices reuse onboarding
- macOS: MDM deployment and required permissions
- Confirm cloud connectivity and policy sync status

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Endpoint settings in Purview

Data loss prevention > Overview > Data loss prevention settings > Endpoint settings

- Documentation
- Settings are used in DLP Policies
- Examples
  - Advanced classification scanning and protection
  - File path exclusion
  - Browser and domain restrictions
  - Removeable media groups
  - Network share groups
  - Printer groups

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Creating a DLP policy

1. Purview > Data loss prevention > Policies > Create policy
2. Choose a template or Custom policy. Name it and select the administrative scope.
3. Select Devices. Limit the pilot to intended users and/or devices.
4. Create a rule with sensitive information types or labels, thresholds and exceptions.
5. Select device activities, actions, notifications and alerts.

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Pilot and enforcement

Test before blocking

Run the policy in simulation mode

Review matches and activity without enforcement

Test all three scenarios with synthetic files

Tune detection, exceptions and user messaging

Enable and monitor

Confirm device configuration and policy sync

Turn on enforcement for the pilot group

Review alerts, overrides and user impact

Expand scope gradually and keep a rollback plan

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End of Module 5

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